



Laurian Kaijage

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ABOUT ME

Mr. Kaijage is a Marine Ecologist at The Nature Conservancy, where he promotes data-driven decision-making and community engagement. He began his career as a research assistant at the University of Dar es Salaam, specializing in collecting DNA barcoding data for fish identification. With a background in R programming, Kaijage is skilled in utilizing data analytics tools and techniques. He is keen to explore the application of machine learning and artificial intelligence for ecological research and conservation

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Master's Degree

School of Aquatic Science and Fisheries Technology - University of Dar es Salaam [

01/07/2022 – 20/09/2024]

City: Dar es Salaam | Country: Tanzania | Website: <https://www.udsm.ac.tz/web/index.php/schools/soaf> |
Field(s) of study: Agriculture, forestry, fisheries and veterinary: • Fisheries | Final grade: Pass | Thesis: The Diversity and Distribution Patterns of Freshwater Fish Species the Lower Rufiji and Pangani Rivers, Tanzania

Bachelor's Degree

University of Dar es Salaam [01/11/2016 – 31/07/2019]

City: Dar es Salaam | Country: Tanzania | Website: www.udsm.ac.tz | Field(s) of study: Agriculture, forestry, fisheries and veterinary: • Fisheries | Final grade: Second Upper Class

Application of GIS in Conservation

Regional Centre for Mapping of Resources for Development (RCMRD) [11/08/2025 – 05/09/2025]

Website: <https://onlinelearning.rcmrd.org/> | Field(s) of study: Natural sciences, mathematics and statistics: • Earth sciences

Leading the Way: Effective Management for Marine Conservation and Biodiversity in Africa

African Leadership University - School of Wildlife Conservation [11/03/2024 – 18/10/2024]

Country: South Africa | Website: <https://sowc.alueducation.com/> | Field(s) of study: Natural sciences, mathematics and statistics: • Natural environments and wildlife

WORK EXPERIENCE

🏢 *The Nature Conservancy – Dar es Salaam, Tanzania*

Website: <https://www.nature.org/en-us/about-us/where-we-work/africa/tanzania/> | Email address: laurianlawrence.kaijage@tnc.org | Name of unit or department: Marine - Business or sector: Agriculture, forestry and fishing

Marine Ecology Officer

[04/05/2026 – Current]

1. Coordinate and support the design, planning, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation of the *Pamoja Tuhifadhi Bahari Yetu*, workplans.
2. Coordinate all fieldwork activities, including preparing data collection protocols and procedures, where possible participating in fieldwork activities, and supporting data collection, entry, analysis, and archiving specifically in Mtwara and Unguja North.
3. Oversee tracking of Pamoja Tuhifadhi Bahari Yetu workplans to ensure timely delivery of activities assigned to TNC are implemented on schedule and deliverables meet EU - IUCN and TNC requirements.
4. Facilitate consultations with communities and partners (including IUCN, WWF, WCS and Forum CC) to create and advance community-based strategies for better managed, productive, and healthier coastal ecosystems.
5. Representing TNC's Oceans Strategy and interests within the country and the WIO region, including development of new partnerships.
6. Coordinate the production of project quarterly and final reports, presentations, communication materials, and assessments on Pamoja Thadani Bahari Yetu.
7. Coordinate fellows, interns, University Students and consultants working on Pamoja Tuhifadhi Bahari Yetu and/or the URT Marine Program to advance program objectives

 **European Union Commission to Tanzania – Dar es Salaam, Tanzania**

Youth Sounding Board member

[01/06/2024 – Current]

As a member of the Youth Sounding Board (YSB), the board advises the EU Ambassador on youth participation and empowerment in key areas such as the blue economy, human capital and employment, and governance.

 **Mwambao Coastal Community – Zanzibar, Tanzania**

Website: <https://mwambao.or.tz/> | Email address: kaijage.laurian@mwambao.or.tz | Business or sector: Agriculture, forestry and fishing

Ecological Data Manager

[26/06/2023 – 30/03/2026]

1. Managing the design and collection of all biological data from field activities
2. Ensuring the quality control of all ecological data collection
3. Cataloguing and filing all data collected and ensuring back-up are made.
4. Carrying out basic data analysis and interpretation of results
5. Development of outputs and reports according to agreed workplans and in a timely manner for funder reporting
6. As required and in line with approved strategic plans, contribute to and support the development of funding proposals, ensuring the accuracy of work planned
7. Contribute to the production of annual work-plans and budgets, in line with annual project budgets and anticipated outcomes

 **Sustainable Ocean Alliance - Tanzania – Dar es Salaam, Tanzania**

Communication manager

[01/06/2023 – Current]

1. Informs members on what they have to know and collects member's ideas and opinions and request
2. Mobilizes members to initiate active participations in organizational activities and projects
3. Acts as a bridge between leaders and members
4. Sends onboarding emails for new members and host meeting with new members to inform them on what they need to know and do in the organization

 **BIOEEL-TZ Project-University of Dar es Salaam – Dar es Salaam, Tanzania**

University research assistant

[04/07/2021 – 19/02/2023]

1. Fish biodiversity data collection and analysis
2. Environmental parameter data collection and analysis
3. Communication of research activities through social media and documentary preparation (find video for reference: <https://youtu.be/xG5QM6aQIzY>)
4. Reporting of scientific findings in international conferences and school level presentations
5. Assistance in facilitating community workshops and capacity building
6. Data entry and cataloging

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): Swahili

Other language(s):

English

LISTENING C1 READING C2 WRITING C1

SPOKEN PRODUCTION C1 SPOKEN INTERACTION C1

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user; B1 and B2: Independent user; C1 and C2: Proficient user

SKILLS

R, R-instant, R-Studio / Microsoft Word / Outlook / Google Drive / Analytical skills / Critical thinking / Good listener and communicator / Microsoft Powerpoint / Microsoft Excel / Microsoft Office

PUBLICATIONS

[2024]

[Assessing the biodiversity of eels of Tanzania -Promoting sustainable fisheries through environmental monitoring and capacity building \(BIOEELS\)](#)

Reinhold Hanel, Lydia Gaspare, Catherine Mwakosya, Claudia Kanyairitha, Laurian Lawrence Kaijage, Ulrike Kammann, Klaus Wysujack

[2024]

[Environmental Monitoring and Genetic Identification of Freshwater Fish Species Enable the Conservation of Biodiversity in Coastal Rivers of Tanzania](#)

Lydia Gaspare, Catherine Mwakosya, Laurian Lawrence Kaijage, Claudia Kanyairitha, Klaus Wysujack, and Reinhold Hanel

[2023]

[Biodiversity of Eels in Pangani and Rufiji Rivers, Tanzania](#)

University of Dar es Salaam

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xG5QM6aQIzY>

[2025]

[Diversity and biological characterization of anguillid eels in Pangani and Rufiji river systems, Tanzania: Implications for conservation](#)

Authors: Laurian, K., Gaspare, L., Wysujack, K., Mwakosya, C., & Hanel, R. | Journal Name: Journal of Fish Biology

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

[04/10/2022 – 10/10/2022] Port Elizabeth, South Africa

12th WIOMSA Symposium Participated as Masters student showcasing the work on anguillid eel research in Tanzania as part of the BIOEEL-Project.

[28/09/2025 – 04/10/2025] Mombasa

13th WIOMSA Symposiums Participated as a science practioners, to learn from other marine scientist in the region especially regarding fisheries and coral restoration initiative but also showcase what I was working on on the same.

Link: <https://symposium.wiomsa.org/>

PROJECTS

[04/05/2026 – Current]

PAMOJA TUHIFADHI BAHARI YETU PROJECT The project is designed to: i) strengthen governance frameworks, legal and technical mechanisms for conserving species and ecosystems, ii) improve institutional capacity, iii) promote community engagement, and iv) support effective research, monitoring and surveillance systems. The overarching goal is to improve environmental protection and biodiversity conservation of the coastal and marine ecosystems in Tanzania.

[26/06/2023 – 30/04/2026]

Blue Action Fund - Increasing socio-ecological resilience through community-led management of key coastal ecosystems in Pemba Channel, Tanzania Grant Programme supports marine conservation projects that are implemented in the efforts to conserve the ocean and improve the livelihoods of coastal communities in Tanzania

[26/06/2023 – 30/12/2024]

ECOFISH - (FROM OCTOPUS CLOSURES TO SUSTAINABLE MARINE RESOURCE MANAGEMENT PLANNING: PROMOTING EQUITABLE GOVERNANCE OF TENURE IN SMALL SCALE FISHING COMMUNITIES IN ZANZIBAR AND NE TANZANIAN COAST THROUGH EXTENDING SUCCESSFUL PILOT INITIATIVES) The EU-funded 6-year long (2018-2024) Ecofish programme aimed to improve policies and frameworks for better management of fisheries in Eastern Africa, Southern Africa and the Indian Ocean Region (EA-SA-IO) through use of data, awareness raising, advocacy and dialogue

[26/06/2023 – 30/06/2025]

NORAD - Building a sustainable and inclusive coastal community marine economy on the East African Coast Through the support of NORAD, project actively engaged with the communities in Mkokotoni, Mtowapwani, Muwanda, Makoba, Mafufuni, Misufini, Bima Subuni, Boma Kichakamiba, Zingibar, Mwaboza, and Moa, Tanzania towards sustainable marine economy

[01/07/2025 – Current]

The Nature Conservancy - Strengthening marine co-management and livelihoods, Tanzania The purpose of the project is to fund activities on 'Strengthening fisheries co-management in Tanga and reef restoration in Pemba Island, Tanzania'

[15/03/2021 – 30/01/2024]

BIOEEL-TZ BIOEELS-TZ followed an interdisciplinary approach to bridge knowledge gaps through a better understanding of the impacts of fisheries and other economic [activities on migratory eels](#). The project was a milestone for awareness raising about unknown natural resources in Tanzania. In addition to gathering scientific information, various stakeholder groups were involved in the project, and public outreach activities targeted different societal groups, such as local fishing communities and schools.

Link: <https://meerwissen.org/partnership-projects/bioeels-tz/>

CERTIFICATIONS

[BCTHubs, 10/07/2025]

Introduction to Scientific Diving

Mode of learning: Presential

[The Nature Conservancy, 12/05/2023]

Waste water Pollution short course

Mode of learning: Online

[The Nature Conservancy, 03/08/2023]

Coral Reef Restoration

Mode of learning: Online

[The Nature Conservancy, 20/05/2023]

Coral Reef Resilience

Mode of learning: Online

[i.a.c, 18/08/2024]

Open Water Diving

Mode of learning: Presential

[SSI, 30/09/2024]

Advanced Open Water Diving

Mode of learning: Work based

[The Nature Conservancy, 28/08/2023]

Global Mangrove Watch

Mode of learning: Online

[World Wild Fund for nature, 03/01/2024]

Community Conservation Enterprise

Mode of learning: Online